Automating Employee Data Import in ServiceNow

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Abstract

This project demonstrates how employee information from an external data source can be automatically imported into ServiceNow. The automation uses Import Sets and Transform Maps to transfer employee data such as name, email, department, manager, and manager email into the system. By implementing dot walking, related information like department and manager email can be displayed directly in the Incident form when an incident is assigned to an employee. Additionally, Dictionary Override is used to modify the default priority value for incidents. This approach improves efficiency, ensures accurate data management, and simplifies incident handling in ServiceNow.

Introduction

ServiceNow is a widely used platform for managing IT services and organizational workflows. In many organizations, employee data is maintained in external systems and must be regularly imported into ServiceNow. Manual entry of such data can be time-consuming and error-prone. Therefore, automation techniques such as Import Sets and Transform Maps are used to import employee data efficiently. This project also demonstrates how dot walking can retrieve related information from different tables

without opening those records. Furthermore, Dictionary Override allows administrators to customize default field values for specific tables like Incident.

Objectives

• Import employee data into ServiceNow automatically.
• Map and transform imported data into the User table.
• Display related information such as department and manager email using dot walking.
• Customize default priority value for incidents using Dictionary Override.

Tools / Concepts Used

• ServiceNow Platform
• Import Sets
• Transform Maps
• Dot Walking
• Dictionary Override

Implementation Steps

- Create employee records in Google Sheets or Excel.
- Save the file and download it in .xlsx or .csv format.
- Upload the file into ServiceNow using Import Sets (Load Data).
- Create an Import Set table for employee data.
- Create a Transform Map to map fields from the Import Set table to the User (sys_user) table.
- Use Auto Mapping and Mapping Assist to match fields correctly.
- Transform the imported data into the target table.
- Use Dot Walking to display department, email, and manager details in the Incident form.
- Use Dictionary Override to change the default priority value for incidents.

Screenshots

Automating Employee Data

Problem Statement:

Your organization wants to regularly import a list of new employees with their details, such as Name, Email, Department, and Manager, from an external system. Once imported, when an Incident is assigned to an employee, the Incident form should automatically show the manager's email of the employee's department. However, the Priority field on the Incident should default to a different value from the other child tables of the Task table because incidents often require urgent attention based on impact and urgency.

Objective:

The objective of this scenario is to automate the import of employee data, display department manager information directly on incidents, and set a custom priority default for incidents to improve data accuracy, provide quick access to relevant information, and streamline the incident resolution process in ServiceNow.

Skills: Import sets, Dot Walking, Dictionary Override

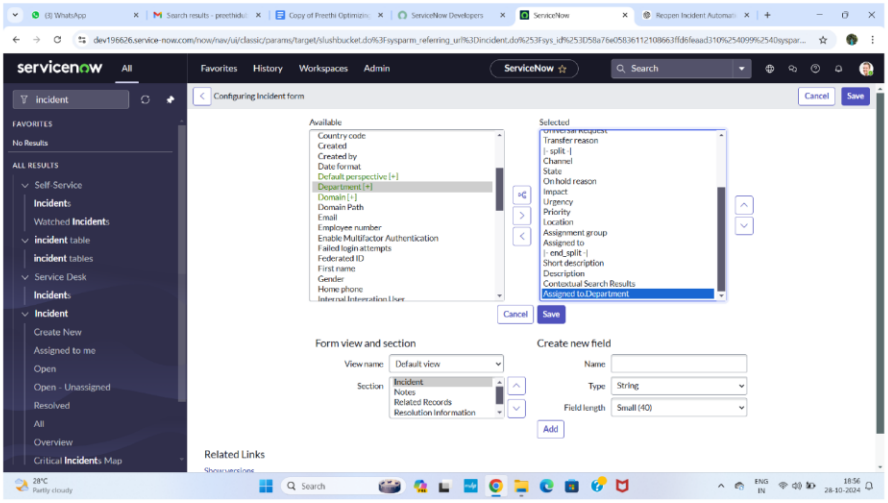
TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Import data from data source

Activity 1: Create records in the Sheet

1. Open google sheet
2. Name the fields as name,email,department manager and manager's email
3. Enter some records
4. Save the sheet as: employee data
5. Download the file as .xlsx , .csv (or) .xml file

Figure: ServiceNow configuration screenshot



10. Add another field assignment.email.
11. Also add assignment.manager field
12. Click on save.

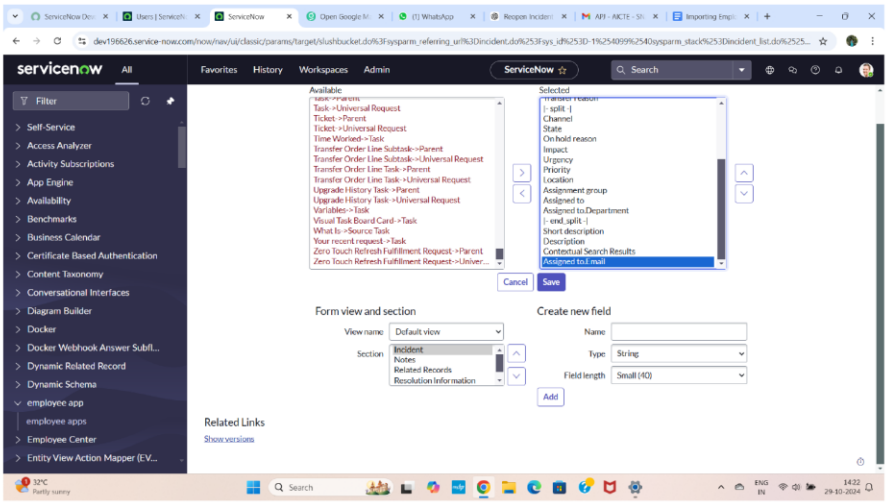
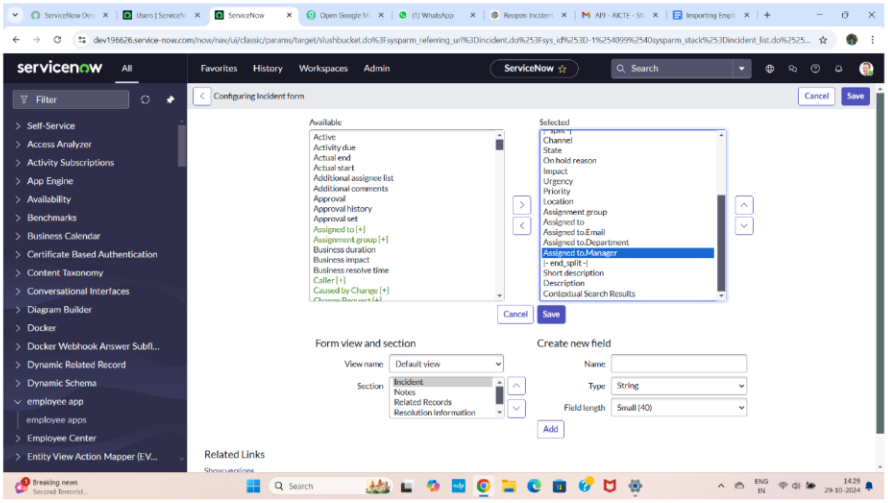


Figure: ServiceNow configuration screenshot



13. Open an incident form
14. Fill the mandatory fields and assigned to just imported user
15. Then department and email field is automatically filled

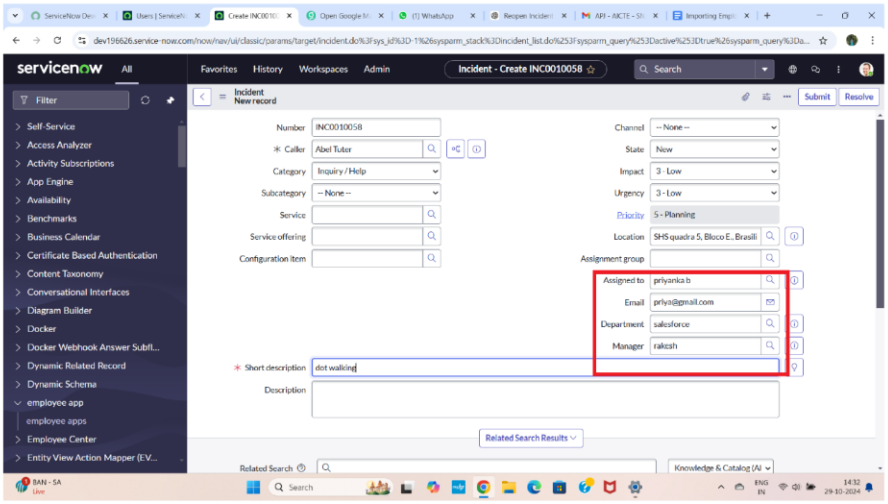
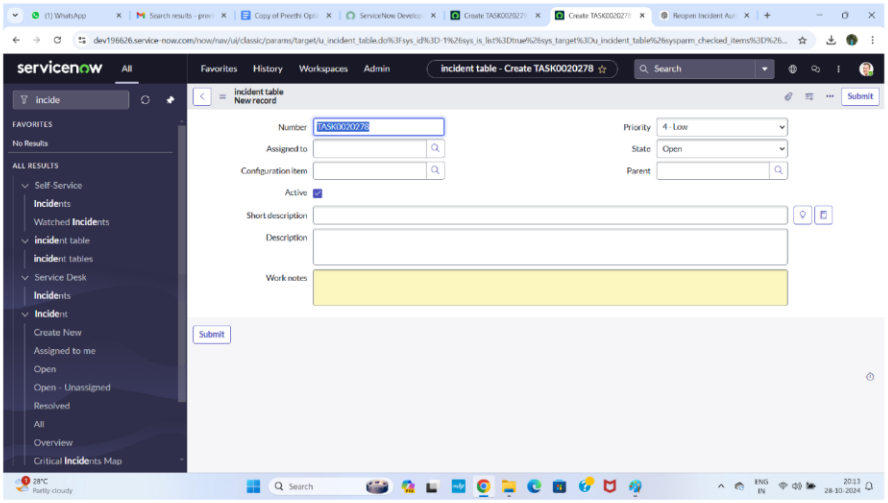


Figure: ServiceNow configuration screenshot

Milestone 3 : Dictionary override

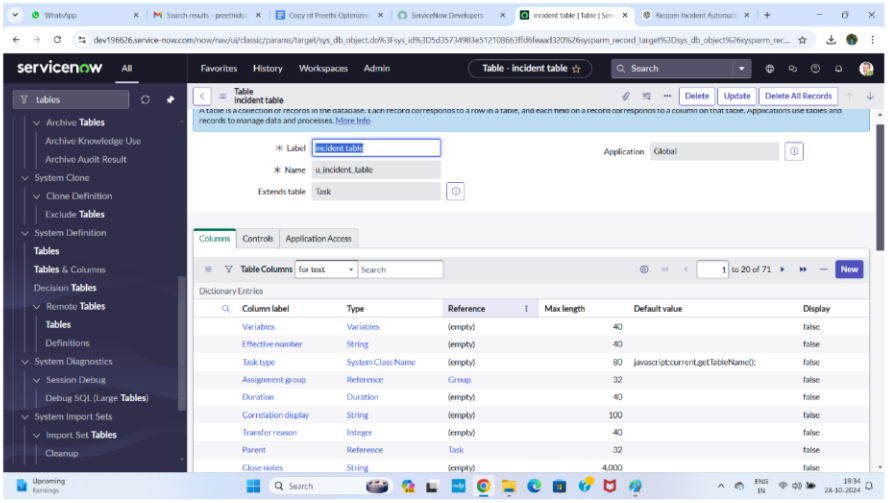
Activity 1: Make the state to 3-moderate in incident

1. Take existing extended table or
2. Create one table as: incident table which is extended from task
3. So task table fields are automatically assign to extended table
4. Open the duplicate tab
5. Click on All> incident table
6. Open the incident table and priority have 4



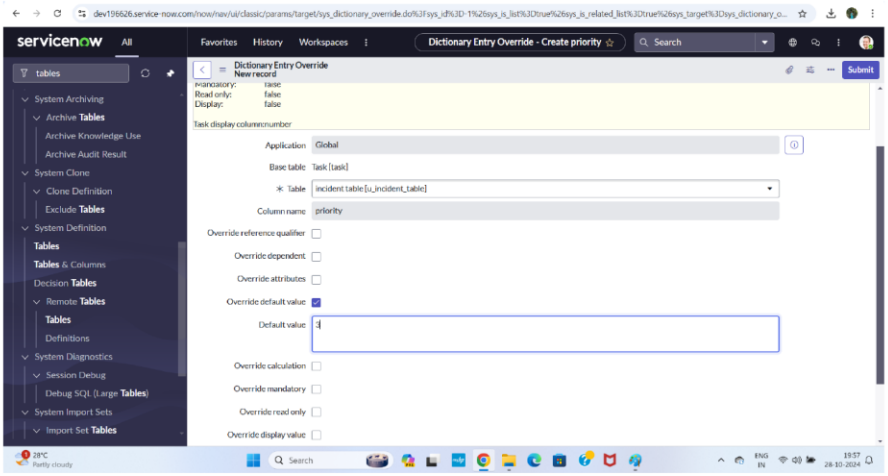
7. Open incident table tab
8. In columns select priority default value is 4 and task table have same default value.

Figure: ServiceNow configuration screenshot



9. Use dictionary override method
10. Change the default value of priority field in one incident table
11. Scrolled down select dictionary override
12. Click on new
13. Select table as: incident table[u_incident_table]
14. Column name is priority
15. Click on override default value
16. Enter default value 3
17. Click on submit

Figure: ServiceNow configuration screenshot



18. Open incident table and check the priority field
19. Priority is changes to 3-moderate

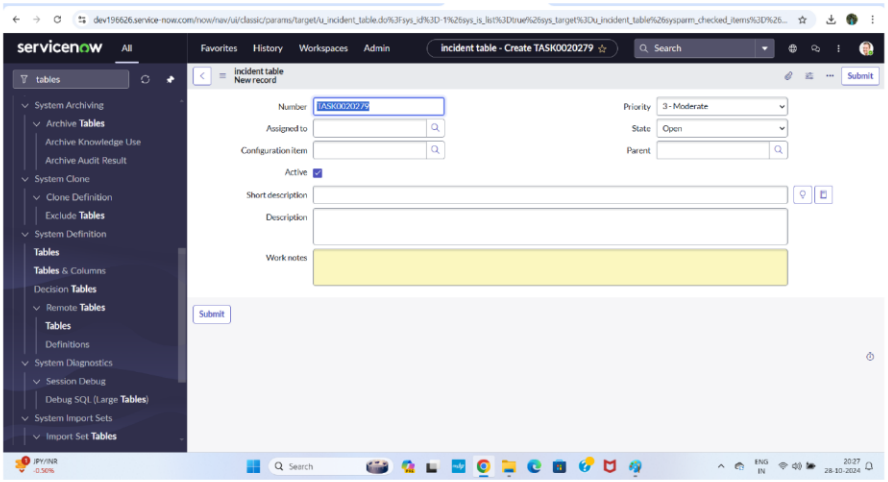
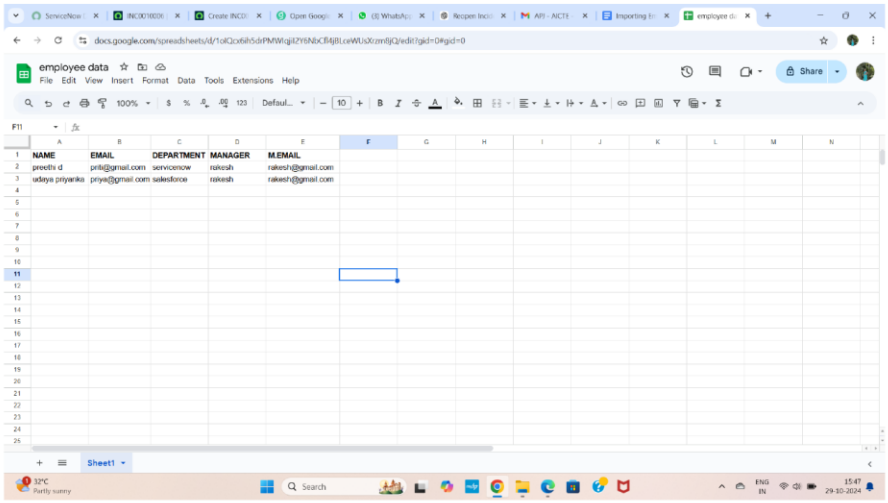


Figure: ServiceNow configuration screenshot

Conclusion :

In this scenario, we streamlined incident management in ServiceNow by automating the import of employee data, displaying department manager information directly on incidents, and setting a custom priority default specifically for incidents. This setup saves time, ensures data accuracy, and gives incident handlers quick access to relevant information, making incident resolution faster and more efficient.

Figure: ServiceNow configuration screenshot



Activity 2: Import data

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for import sets
3. Select load data under system import sets
4. select create table
5. Give the the import set table name as: import employee
6. Choose the file which we created in the XL sheet.

Figure: ServiceNow configuration screenshot

Conclusion

The automation of employee data import in ServiceNow reduces manual work and improves accuracy. Import Sets and Transform Maps simplify the process of bringing external data into the system. Dot walking allows quick access to related information directly in forms, while Dictionary Override enables customization of default values. Together, these features help streamline incident management and improve operational efficiency.